movement to northeast India and also reduce congestion through the Siliguri's 'Chicken's Neck' corridor.

- Connectivity is an issue of mutual interest as these initiatives on passenger and goods trains will be of benefit to both Bangladesh and northeast India.
- Dhaka also has the central role in shaping the future of sub-regional cooperation with Bhutan, Burma, India and Nepal. It is also a land bridge to East Asia and the fulcrum of a future Bay of Bengal community.
- However, the most important issue in contemporary Asian geopolitics is transit and connectivity. In 2016 when Chinese President Xi Jinping visited Bangladesh, it agreed to join the Belt and Road Initiative (BRI).
- China is already investing in a number of infrastructure projects in the country including the deep sea port at Chittagong. It is likely that these projects will now be subsumed under the BRI project which is the matter of concern for India.

### Energy Cooperation

- Energy cooperation between the two sides has also shown a lot of positivity with Indian state Tripura supplying a total of 160 MW of power to Bangladesh in addition to the 500 MW the country is receiving from West Bengal since 2013.
- Bangladesh has sought extra 100 MW electricity from India to solve its power crisis, and will be likely on the negotiating table.

### Defence Cooperation

- There are talks that a defence treaty is to be signed between India and Bangladesh, it will be a long-term defence deal that will allow for increased defence cooperation, information sharing, joint exercises, training and so on. However, India needs to figure out where it can meet Bangladesh's security concerns, considering Bangladesh's largest defence partner is China.
- Expanding security cooperation with India could only enhance Dhaka's global leverage. For India, a strong partnership with Bangladesh will help boost the prospects of peace and prosperity in the eastern subcontinent.
- Defence deal between the two nations on the basis of sovereign equality and geopolitical realities will take us a long way ahead.

The India-Bangladesh relations can be summarised as hanging on three 'T's – 1. Tackling Terrorism, 2. Trade + Transit and 3. Teesta Treaty. we should hope to resolve the issues and take the relationship forward so that the growing mutual trust and political comfort between Delhi and Dhaka will have a long-term consequence. It is important for India's North-East as well.

## 10.4 India-China Relations



The Modern history of India-China relations starts after 1949, with China becoming a Communist country. India was one of the first country to recognise the People's Republic of China. However, the initial relationship did not last long as India became suspicious of China's intention when Tibet was occupied by the Chinese army in 1950. The Hindi – Chini – Bhai Bhai (Indians and Chinese are brothers)



12th_Political Science_Unit_10.indd 220 1/30/2020 4:13:35 PM